

NovaTech Solutions

Employee Handbook & HR Policy Guide

Version 3.2 — Effective January 2026

1. Leave Policy

1.1 Annual Leave

All full-time employees are entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued at a rate of 1.5 days per month. Annual leave must be requested at least 5 working days in advance through the HR portal and approved by the employee's direct manager. Unused annual leave can be carried forward to the next year up to a maximum of 7 days; any leave beyond this cap is forfeited at year end unless special approval is granted by HR.

1.2 Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 12 days of paid sick leave annually. For absences exceeding 2 consecutive working days, a medical certificate from a licensed physician must be submitted to HR within 3 working days of returning to work. Sick leave does not carry forward to the next year. Employees who exhaust their sick leave balance may apply for unpaid medical leave, subject to manager and HR approval.

1.3 Maternity and Paternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to 90 calendar days of fully paid maternity leave, which may begin up to 2 weeks before the expected delivery date. Male employees are entitled to 7 working days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 30 days of the child's birth. Requests for maternity or paternity leave should be submitted to HR at least 30 days in advance where possible, accompanied by relevant medical documentation.

1.4 Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to 5 paid working days of bereavement leave in the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling), and up to 2 paid working days for extended family members. No advance notice is required, but employees should inform their manager and HR as soon as practically possible.

2. Remote Work Policy

2.1 Eligibility

Employees who have completed a minimum of 6 months of continuous employment and maintain a performance rating of 'Meets Expectations' or higher are eligible to apply for remote work arrangements. Approval is granted by the department head on a case-by-case basis depending on role requirements and team operational needs. Roles requiring physical presence (e.g., lab technicians, on-site support engineers) are not eligible for full remote arrangements.

2.2 Hybrid Schedule

Approved remote employees under the standard hybrid policy are required to be present in the office a minimum of 2 days per week, typically Tuesday and Thursday, unless otherwise agreed with their manager. Core collaboration hours for all remote and hybrid employees are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time, during which employees must be reachable via Slack or company email.

2.3 Equipment and Expenses

The company provides a one-time home office setup allowance of \$400 for approved remote employees, covering items such as desks, chairs, and monitors. A monthly internet stipend of \$30 is also provided. All equipment purchased through company funds remains company property and must be returned upon termination of employment.

3. Code of Conduct

3.1 Workplace Behavior

All employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind will not be tolerated and may result in disciplinary action up to and including immediate termination. Employees who witness or experience such conduct are encouraged to report it confidentially to HR or through the anonymous ethics hotline.

3.2 Confidentiality

Employees must not disclose proprietary company information, client data, or trade secrets to any external party during or after their employment, except as required by law. Violation of confidentiality obligations may result in termination and potential legal action. All employees are required to sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) as part of their onboarding.

3.3 Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any outside business activities, financial interests, or relationships that could reasonably be seen as conflicting with the company's interests. This includes accepting gifts from vendors or clients valued at more than \$50, which must be reported to and approved by a

direct manager.

4. Compensation and Benefits

4.1 Salary Reviews

Salary reviews are conducted annually in March, based on individual performance, team contributions, and overall company performance. Promotions and corresponding salary adjustments are not guaranteed annually and are subject to budget availability and role vacancy at the next level.

4.2 Health Insurance

All full-time employees are enrolled in the company group health insurance plan after completing a 30-day probation period. The plan covers the employee and up to 3 dependents, including coverage for outpatient consultations, hospitalization, and a limited dental and vision benefit of \$500 per year per dependent.

4.3 Retirement Contributions

The company matches employee retirement fund contributions up to 5% of gross monthly salary, provided the employee contributes at least an equal amount. Matching contributions vest fully after 2 years of continuous service.

5. Termination and Resignation

5.1 Resignation Notice Period

Employees who wish to resign must provide a minimum of 30 days' written notice to their manager and HR. Employees in senior or specialized technical roles (Lead Engineer and above) are required to provide 60 days' notice. Failure to serve the full notice period may result in forfeiture of the final month's salary, unless waived in writing by HR.

5.2 Termination for Cause

The company reserves the right to terminate employment immediately, without notice or severance, in cases of gross misconduct, including but not limited to theft, fraud, harassment, or serious breach of confidentiality obligations. In all other termination cases, the company will provide notice or payment in lieu of notice equivalent to the employee's resignation notice period.

5.3 Exit Process

Departing employees must complete an exit interview with HR, return all company property (laptops, access cards, equipment), and settle any outstanding expense claims within 5 working days of their last working day. Final settlement, including unused annual leave encashment, will be processed within 15 working days of the last working day.